

As one of India's most productive partnerships in politics comes to an acrimonious end, Mulayam and his former confidant will miss each other

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MULAYAM
AND AMAR

LIFE WITHOUT MULAYAM SINGH

- Won't be playing king-maker or the saviour of governments-in-distress for a while.
- Won't get to quote Urdu couplets on national tv all that often. Even his blog could lose its readership.
- Needs to cultivate a mass following that goes beyond the two Jayas.
- Is vulnerable without political clout to shield him from his court cases.

leave," Amar told INDIA TODAY. Five days later the SP delivered his gift, wrapped in bitter acrimony. Mohan Singh, the newly appointed Thakur spokesman in his place, accused him of "infiltrating the party with capitalism and communalism". That hurt. "For 14 years they were gung-ho about the same man they are now calling a fixer. Suddenly, they are finding fault with me. Whatever I did, had Mulayam's backing. By attacking me they are attacking him," said Amar. In the 1990s, before he joined, the SP had recruited a large number of members with criminal antecedents, like Madan Bhaiyya, D.P. Yadav and Phoolan Devi. The infamous guest house incident, when SP goons attacked Mayawati in 1995, also predated Amar. "I would rather be associated with an

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